

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 86 Handout — A backup you never restore is fan fiction

9 - Advanced & Enterprise · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — DR words mapped to Azure knobs

Term	Meaning	Lab-sized control
RPO	How much data loss is acceptable	Write a target (e.g. 24h lab notes) — label it TARGET
RTO	How fast you must be back	Write a target (e.g. 4h) — measure a drill, do not invent
Soft delete	Recover a deleted secret/blob	Key Vault enableSoftDelete + secret recover
Local HA	Disk / zone / slot swap	Not DR. Same-region nicer failure
Geo	GRS/GZRS / paired region	Costs money; skip buy for a hello lab unless you drill it
Drill	Restore once on purpose	Recover a dummy secret or restore a backup

Architecture B — pick the cheapest proof that is still a restore

Need	Default lab move	Overkill today
Prove restore exists	Dummy Key Vault secret: delete → recover	Paid GRS on a storage account you will kill
Vault already soft-delete on	az keyvault show and record the flag	Rebuild a vault to tick a box
App files	Redeploy last artifact (that is RTO for compute)	ASR on a personal VM you do not have
'Zero RPO / instant RTO'	Rewrite as a wish; pick numbers you could fund	Post those numbers as achievements
Same-region backup only	Call it backup, not DR	Slide titled 'geo-redundant' with LRS

Architecture C — pitfalls that keep the fiction in the policy

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
Never restored	Beautiful backup policy, wrong password on the day	Drill once; time it
Vault in the fire	Backup in the same region as the app and the laptop notes	Say so in the doc; do not call it DR
Soft delete off (legacy)	Deleted secret is gone	az keyvault update / new vault defaults
Purge on a drill	You purge instead of recover	secret recover; purge is the opposite lesson
Work vault screenshot	Company Key Vault in the post	Personal vault or skip the screenshot

One-liner to remember

Backups you never restore are fan fiction.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal subscription. Use a lab Key Vault you already own, or skip geo-SKU spend. Targets are labeled TARGET, not trophies.

- 1 Write RPO and RTO targets for the fictional lab app in docs/dr-day86.md. Label them TARGET. 'Zero / instant' is a wish — rewrite it.
- 2 az keyvault list -o table on the personal sub. Pick one lab vault (or record that you have none and stop before buying geo).

- 3 az keyvault show -n <vault> --query "{soft:properties.enableSoftDelete,purge:properties.enablePurgeProtection}". Soft delete should be true on modern vaults.
- 4 Drill: set a dummy secret drill-day86=temp, delete it, then az keyvault secret recover. Write the elapsed time.
- 5 State in the markdown whether this is backup (same region) or DR (paired region / second stamp). Do not call LRS a DR plan.
- 6 If you cannot restore today, write 'DR plan is still fiction' — that sentence is the lesson.

CLI — a restore with training wheels (Key Vault soft delete)

```
az keyvault show -n kv-azure100-lab --query "{soft:properties.enableSoftDelete,purge:properties.enablePurgeProtection}"
az keyvault secret set --vault-name kv-azure100-lab --name drill-day86 --value temp-only
az keyvault secret delete --vault-name kv-azure100-lab --name drill-day86
az keyvault secret recover --vault-name kv-azure100-lab --name drill-day86
az keyvault secret delete --vault-name kv-azure100-lab --name drill-day86
# Time the recover. A number you did not measure is not an RTO.
```

Done checklist

- RPO/RTO written as TARGETs, not achievements
- One restore drill completed, or an explicit 'still fiction' sentence
- Soft-delete flag recorded
- Did not call same-region backup a DR story
- docs/dr-day86.md on the personal repo

Tomorrow — Day 87

Azure Landing Zones — city planning on paper for a clearly fictional company